

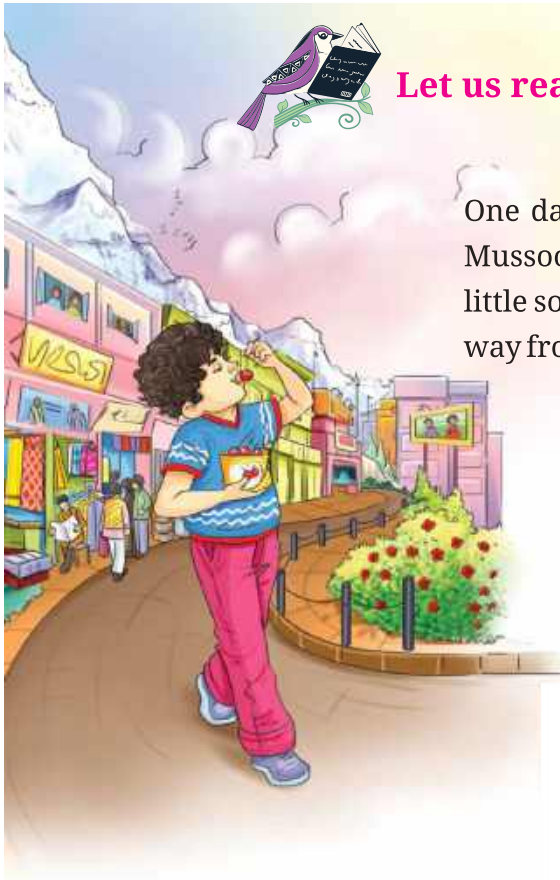


THE CHERRY TREE

Let us do these activities before we read.

- I Work in pairs and answer the questions that follow. Share your answers with your classmates and teacher.
 1. Have you ever used a seed or a sapling to grow a plant ?
 2. What kind of care did the plant need ?
 3. Who helped you with it ?
 4. How did you feel when you saw the plant grow ?
- II What kind of trees do people plant in their homes? Why is it important to plant trees ?
- III Name some fruit trees that grow in your region. What type of conditions help these fruit trees to grow ?





Let us read



I

One day, when Rakesh was six, he walked home from the Mussoorie bazaar eating cherries. They were a little sweet, a little sour; small, bright red cherries, which had come all the way from the Kashmir Valley.

Here in the Himalayan foothills where Rakesh lived, there were not many fruit trees. The soil was stony, and the dry cold winds **stunted** the growth of most plants. But on the more sheltered slopes there were forests of oak and deodar.

Rakesh lived with his grandfather on the **outskirts** of Mussoorie, just where the forest began. His father and mother lived in a small village fifty miles away, where they grew maize

and rice and barley in narrow **terraced fields** on the lower slopes of the mountain.

But there were no schools in the village, and Rakesh's parents were keen that he should go to school. As soon as he was of school-going age, they sent him to stay with his grandfather in Mussoorie.

He had a little cottage outside the town.

Rakesh was on his way home from school when he bought the cherries. He paid fifty paise for the bunch. It took him about half-an-hour to walk home, and by the time he reached the cottage there were only three cherries left.

'Have a cherry, Grandfather,' he said, as soon as he saw his grandfather in the garden.

Grandfather took one cherry and Rakesh promptly ate the other two. He kept the last seed in his mouth for some time, rolling it round and round on his tongue until all the **tang** had gone. Then he placed the seed on the palm of his hand and studied it.

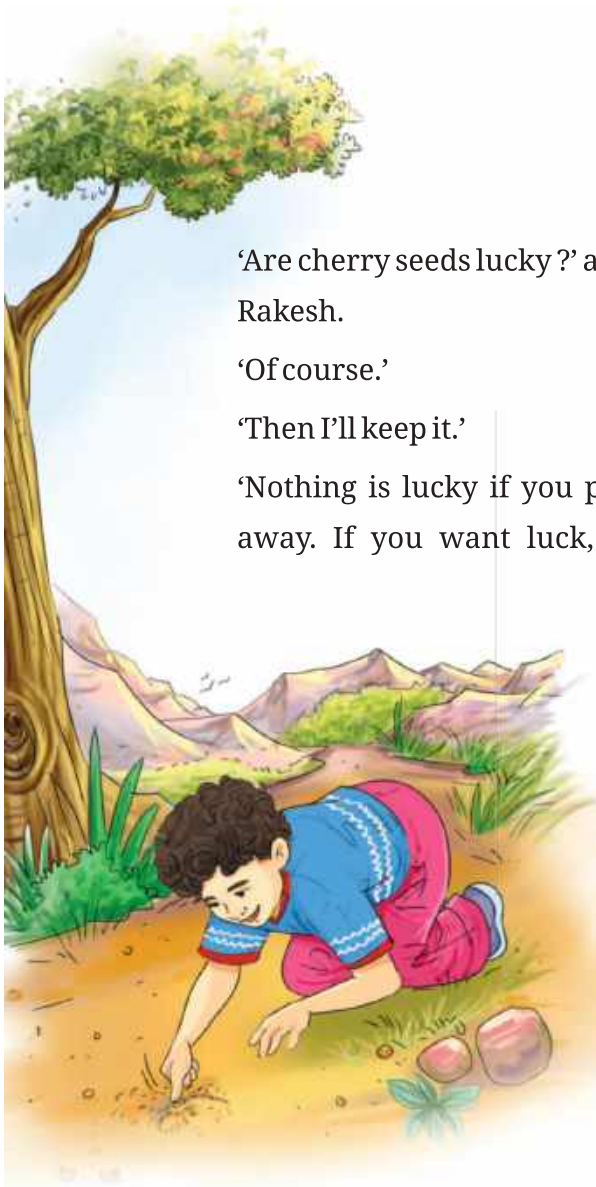
stunted: stopped (from growing to the usual size)

outskirts: the areas that form the edge of a town or city

terraced fields: agricultural areas carved into slopes or hill sides in a step like pattern.

tang : a strong, sharp taste





‘Are cherry seeds lucky?’ asked Rakesh.

‘Of course.’

‘Then I’ll keep it.’

‘Nothing is lucky if you put it away. If you want luck, you



must put it to some use.’

‘What can I do with a seed?’

‘Plant it.’

So Rakesh found a small space and began to dig up a flowerbed.

‘Hey, not there,’ said Grandfather. ‘I’ve sown

mustard in that bed. Plant it in that shady corner, where it won’t be disturbed.’

Rakesh went to a corner of the garden where the earth was soft and **yielding**. He did not have to dig.

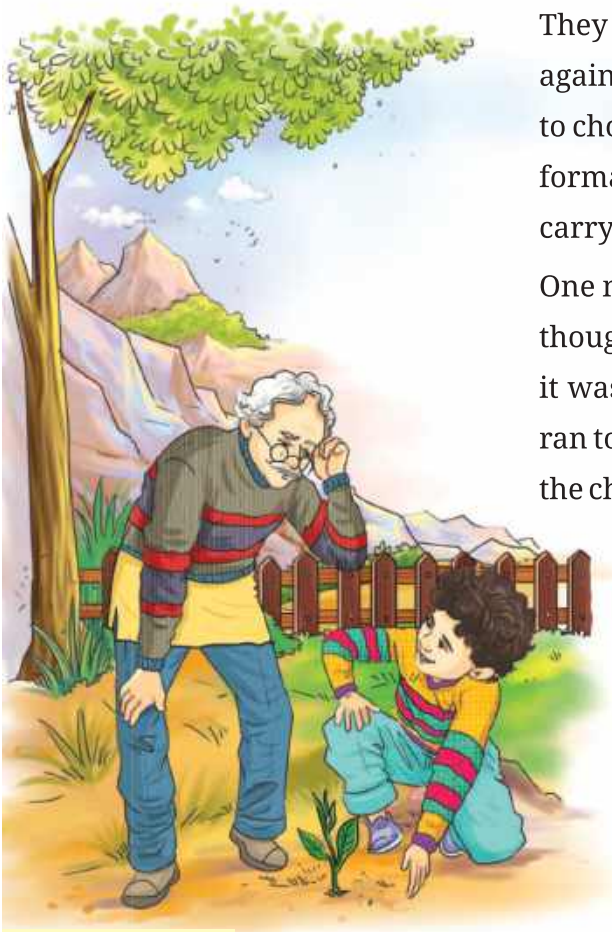
He pressed the seed into the soil with his thumb and it went right in.

Then he had his lunch, and ran off to play cricket with his friends, and forgot all about the cherry seed.

When it was winter in the hills, a cold wind blew down from the snows and went whoo-who-who in the deodar trees, and the garden was dry and bare.

yielding:
giving
way under
pressure





haunches: sit on the feet with legs bent

peered down: looked carefully or with difficulty

Sprinkling: Statlering or spreading small amounts of something (like water power or particles) over a surface.

They knew it was spring when the wild duck flew north again, to Siberia. Early in the morning, when he got up to chop wood and light a fire, Rakesh saw the V-shaped formation streaming northward, the calls of the birds carrying clearly through the thin mountain air.

One morning in the garden he bent to pick up what he thought was a small twig and found to his surprise that it was well rooted. He stared at it for a moment, then ran to fetch Grandfather, calling, ‘Dada, come and look, the cherry tree has come up!’

‘What cherry tree?’ asked Grandfather, who had forgotten about it. ‘The seed we planted last year—look, it’s come up!’

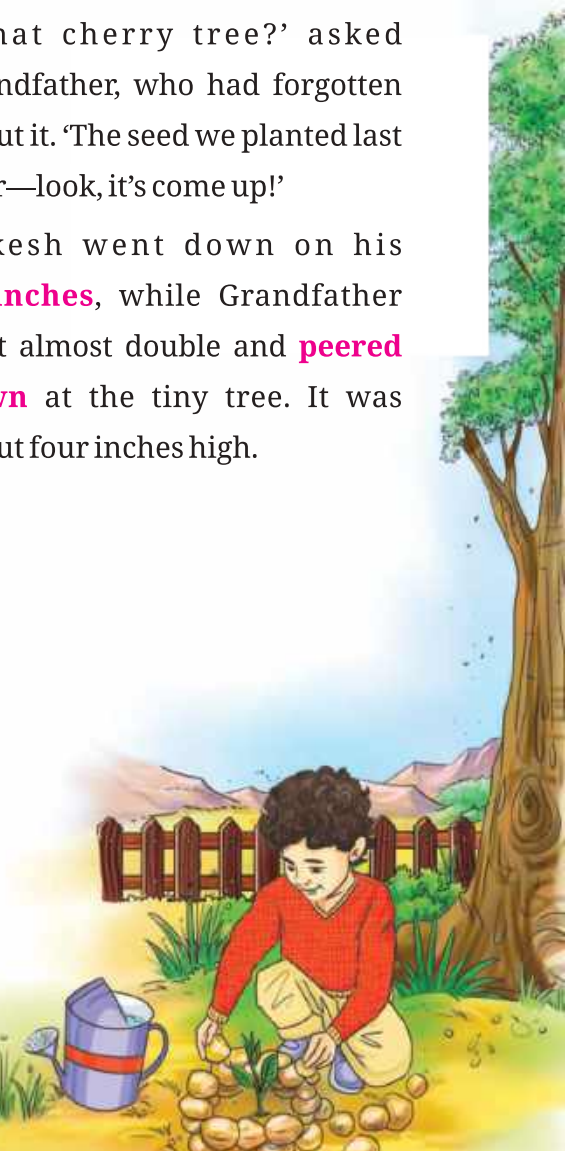
Rakesh went down on his **haunches**, while Grandfather bent almost double and **peered down** at the tiny tree. It was about four inches high.

‘Yes, it’s a cherry tree,’ said Grandfather. ‘You should water it now and then.’

Rakesh ran indoors and came back with a bucket of water.

‘Don’t drown it!’ said Grandfather.

Rakesh gave it a **sprinkling** and circled it with pebbles.



‘What are the pebbles for?’ asked Grandfather.

‘For privacy,’ said Rakesh.

He looked at the tree every morning but it did not seem to be growing very fast, so he stopped looking at it except quickly, out of the corner of his eye. And, after a week or two, when he allowed himself to look at it properly, he found that it had grown—at least an inch !

That year the monsoon rains came early and Rakesh **plodded** to and from school in raincoat and chappals. Even if sprang from the trunks of trees, strange-looking lilies came up in the long grass. Even If it wasn’t raining the trees dripped and mist came curling up the valley. The cherry tree grew quickly in this season.

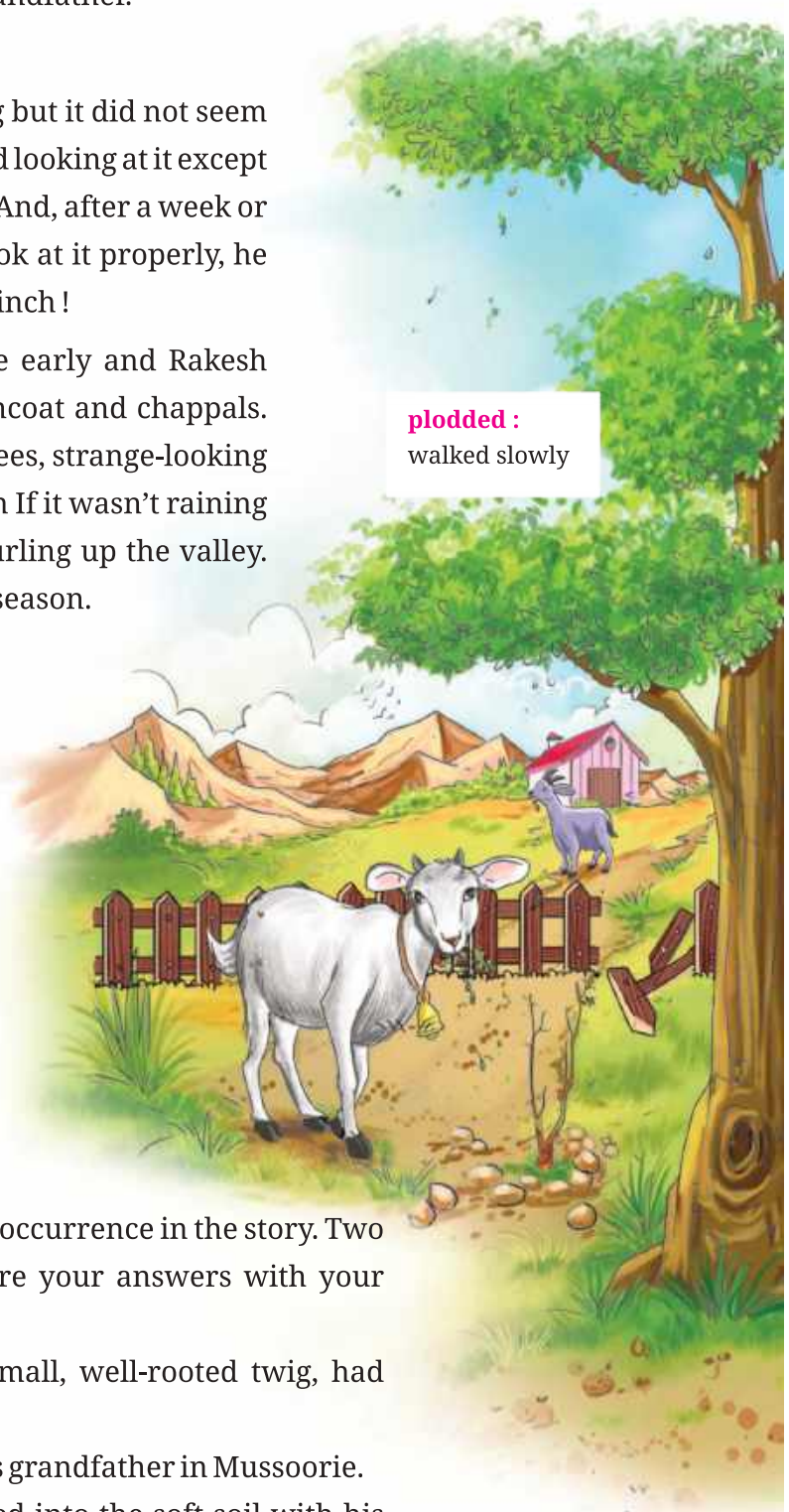
It was about two feet high when a goat entered the garden and ate all the leaves. Only the main stem and two thin branches remained.

‘Never mind,’ said Grandfather, seeing that Rakesh was upset. ‘It will grow again, cherry trees are tough.’

Let us discuss

- I Arrange the events in order of occurrence in the story. Two have been done for you. Share your answers with your classmates and the teacher.
1. Rakesh discovered that the small, well-rooted twig, had grown into a cherry tree.
 2. Rakesh was sent to live with his grandfather in Mussoorie.
 3. Rakesh pressed the cherry seed into the soft soil with his thumb.
 4. The cherry tree grew quickly after the rains arrived early.

plodded :
walked slowly





scrambled:
moved quickly
and with
difficulty

scythe: a tool
with a long,
sharp, curved
blade with a
long handle

foliage: green
leaves

Sturdy: strongly
(adj)

5. Rakesh bought a bunch of cherries and ate most of them.
 6. A goat entered the garden and ate all the leaves of the young cherry tree.
 7. Rakesh's parents grew maize, rice, and barley in a village. (1)
 8. Rakesh sprinkled water on the cherry tree and surrounded it with pebbles.
 9. Grandfather told Rakesh that cherry trees were tough.
 10. Rakesh kept rolling the last cherry seed in his mouth.
- II Do you think the cherry tree would survive? Why do you think so?

II

Towards the end of the rainy season new leaves appeared on the tree. Then a woman cutting grass **scrambled** down the hillside, her **scythe** swishing through the heavy monsoon **foliage**. She did not try to avoid the tree: one sweep, and the cherry tree was cut in two. When Grandfather saw what had happened, he went after the woman and scolded her;

but the damage could not be repaired.

‘Maybe it will die now,’ said Rakesh.

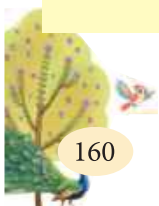
‘Maybe,’ said Grandfather.

But the cherry tree had no intention of dying.

By the time summer came round again, it had sent out several new shoots with tender green leaves.

Rakesh had grown taller too. He was eight now, a **sturdy** boy with curly black hair and deep black eyes. Blackberry eyes, Grandfather called them.

That monsoon Rakesh went home to his village, to help his father and mother with the planting and ploughing and sowing. He was thinner but



stronger when he came back to Grandfather's house at the end of the rains to find that the cherry tree had grown another foot. It was now up to his chest.

Even when there was rain, Rakesh would sometimes water the tree. He wanted it to know that he was there.

One day he found a bright green **praying-mantis perched** on a branch, peering at him with **bulging** eyes. Rakesh let it remain there; it was the cherry tree's first visitor.

praying-mantis:
an insect

Perched: rested

bulging: Swelling
outwards in a
rounded shape

The next visitor was a hairy caterpillar, who started making a meal of the leaves. Rakesh removed it quickly and dropped it on a heap of dry leaves.

'Come back when you're a butterfly,'
he said.

Winter came early. The cherry tree bent low with the weight of snow. Field-mice sought shelter in the roof of the cottage. The road from the valley was blocked, and for several days there was no newspaper, and this made Grandfather quite **grumpy**. His stories began to have unhappy endings.

In February it was Rakesh's birthday. He was nine—and the tree was four, but almost as tall as Rakesh.

One morning, when the sun came out, Grandfather came into the garden to let some warmth 'get into my bones,' as he put it. He stopped in front of the cherry tree, stared at it for a few moments, and then called out, 'Rakesh! Come and look! Come quickly before it falls!'

Rakesh and Grandfather **gazed** at the tree as though it had performed a miracle. There was a pale pink blossom at the end of a branch.

The following year there were more blossoms.

And suddenly the tree was taller than Rakesh, even though it was less than half his age. And then it was taller than Grandfather, who was older than some of the oak trees.



grumpy:
badtempered

gazed: looked at
something for a
long time with
admiration



nectar: Sugary fluid secreted within flowers.

flitted: flew quickly

reclining: lying back

But Rakesh had grown too. He could run and jump and climb trees as well as most boys, and he read a lot of books, although he still liked listening to Grandfather's tales.

In the cherry tree, bees came to feed on the **nectar** in the blossoms, and tiny birds pecked at the blossoms and broke them off. But the tree kept blossoming right through the spring, and there were always more blossoms than birds.

That summer there were small cherries on the tree. Rakesh tasted one and spat it out.

'It's too sour,' he said.



'They'll be better next year,' said Grandfather.

But the birds liked them—especially the bigger birds, such as the bulbuls and scarlet minivets—and they **flitted** in and out of the foliage, feasting on the cherries.

On a warm sunny afternoon, when even the bees looked sleepy, Rakesh was looking for Grandfather without finding him in any of his favourite places around the house. Then he looked out of the bedroom window and saw Grandfather **reclining** on a cane chair under the cherry tree.

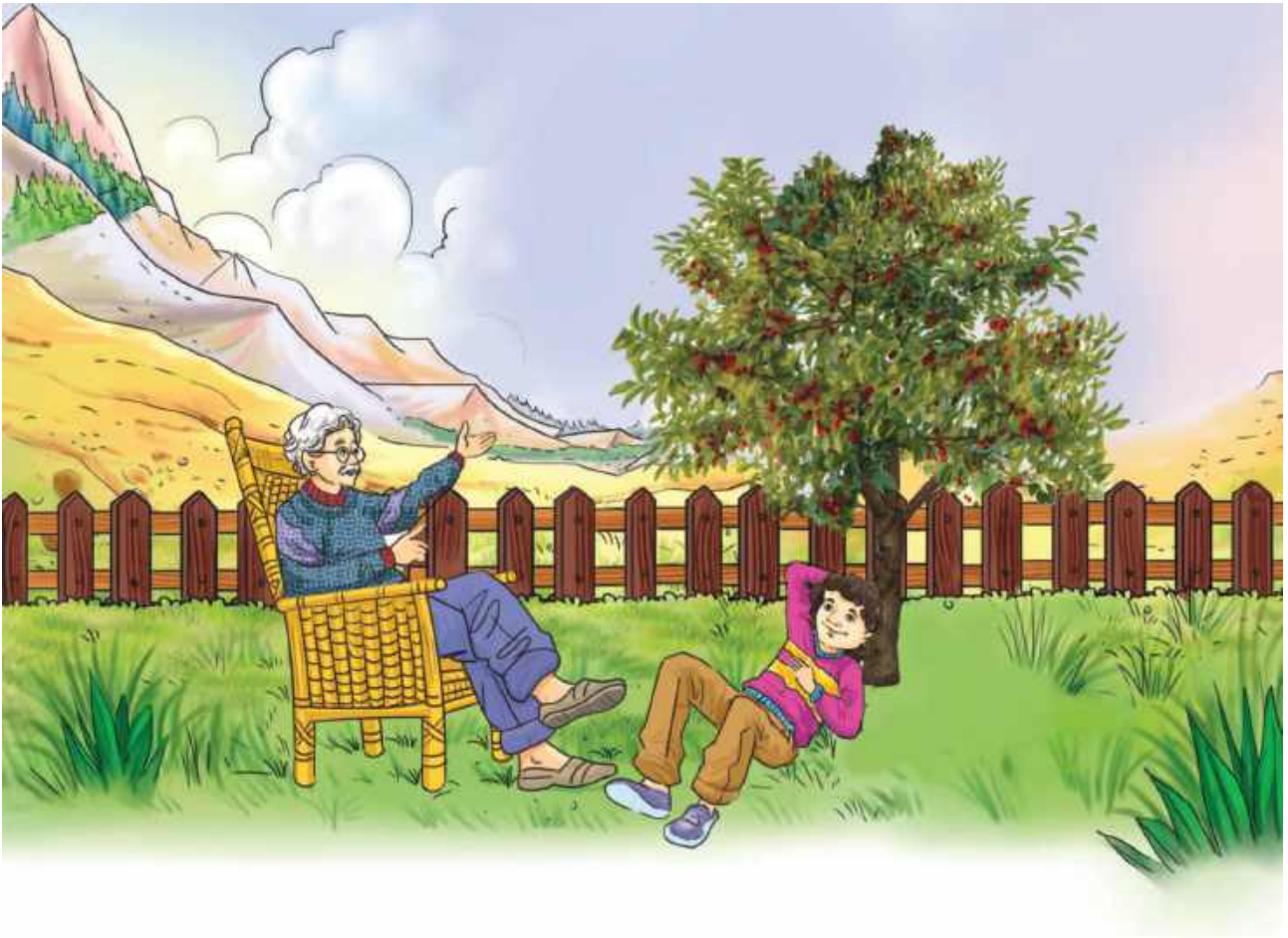
Striding: cross with a long step in a direction

'There's just the right amount of shade here,' said Grandfather. 'And I like looking at the leaves.'

'They're pretty leaves,' said Rakesh. 'And they are always ready to dance, if there's a breeze.'

After Grandfather had come indoors, Rakesh went into the garden and lay down on the grass beneath the tree. He gazed up through the leaves at the great blue sky; and turning on his side, he could see the mountains **striding** away into the clouds.





He was still lying beneath the tree when the evening shadows crept across the garden. Grandfather came back and sat down beside Rakesh, and they waited in silence until the stars came out and the **nightjar** began to call. In the forest below, the crickets and **cicadas** began tuning up; and suddenly the trees were full of the sound of insects.

‘There are so many trees in the forest,’ said Rakesh. ‘What’s so special about this tree? Why do we like it so much?’

‘We planted it ourselves,’ said Grandfather. ‘That’s why it’s special.’

‘Just one small seed,’ said Rakesh, and he touched the smooth bark of the tree that he had grown. He ran his hand along the trunk of the tree and put his finger to the tip of a leaf. ‘I wonder,’ he whispered. ‘Is this what it feels to be God?’

nightjar: a bird

cicadas: insects known for their loud distinctive calls, especially during evenings

Ruskin Bond



Let us discuss

- I Complete the table given below based on your understanding of Part II of the story. One example has been done for you. Share your answers with your classmates and teacher.



Cause	Effect
1. A woman cut the cherry tree while cutting grass.	(i) Grandfather scolded the woman.
2.	(ii) Rakesh was thinner but stronger when he came back.
3. A hairy caterpillar started eating the leaves of the cherry tree.	(iii)
4.	(iv) Rakesh and Grandfather gazed at the tree as though it was a miracle.
5. Rakesh tasted one of the small cherries during summer.	(v)



Let us think and reflect

- I Read the given extracts and answer the questions that follow.

1. "Have a cherry, Grandfather," he said, as soon as he saw his grandfather in the garden.

Grandfather took one cherry and Rakesh promptly ate the other two. He kept the last seed in his mouth for some time, rolling it round and round on his tongue until all the tang had gone. Then he placed the seed on the palm of his hand and studied it.

"Are cherry seeds lucky?" asked Rakesh.

"Of course."

"Then I'll keep it."

"Nothing is lucky if you put it away. If you want luck, you must put it to some use."



- (i) Substitute the underlined phrase with a correct word from the extract.

The Kho-kho captain changed her strategy *quickly and without delay* when a new player came in from the opposing team.

- (ii) What does Rakesh's action of rolling the cherry seed in his mouth most likely suggest about his mood at that moment?

- A. He is feeling impatient and restless.
- B. He is enjoying the taste and the moment.
- C. He is bored and has nothing better to do.
- D. He is thoughtful and feeling playful.

- (iii) Complete the following sentence suitably with reference to Rakesh and his grandfather.

Rakesh's decision to plant the seed shows that _____.

(he respects and values his grandfather's advice/he has a close bond with his grandfather and a willingness to learn from him)

- (iv) What is grandfather's view about luck?



2. *Winter came early. The cherry tree bent low with the weight of snow. Field-mice sought shelter in the roof of the cottage. The road from the valley was blocked, and for several days there was no newspaper, and this made Grandfather quite grumpy. His stories began to have unhappy endings.*

In February it was Rakesh's birthday. He was nine—and the tree was four, but almost as tall as Rakesh.

- (i) Complete the following sentence suitably.

The phrase '*field-mice sought shelter in the roof of the cottage*' suggests that _____.

- (ii) What can be inferred about the cherry tree's toughness from the line, '*The cherry tree bent low with the weight of snow*'?

- A. The weight of the tree was more than the snow.
- B. The tree could withstand harsh weather.
- C. The tree was growing close to the ground.
- D. The snow gave support to the tree.

- (iii) How did the early winter affect Grandfather's mood and storytelling?



- (iv) Complete the sentence by choosing the correct option.

The comparison of Rakesh's age to the cherry tree's age symbolises _____. (the tree's growth paralleling Rakesh's own development/the tree standing as a dear one on Rakesh's birthday)

II Answer the following questions.

1. Why did Rakesh's parents send him to Mussoorie ?
2. Why did Rakesh let the praying-mantis remain on the branch of the cherry tree?
3. How is life in the Himalayan foothills described in the story ?
4. What might Rakesh mean when he says, "Is this what it feels to be God?" at the end of the story ?
5. How does the writer describe the relationship between Rakesh and his grandfather ?
6. What can you infer about the connection between humans and nature based on the story ?
7. Imagine Rakesh reflects on his wonderful experience of watching a seed being transformed into a full-grown cherry tree. Write how he must have felt.



Let us learn

- I Each word list has one word that does not match with the other words. Identify the odd word. One example has been done for you.

Example: chop, trim, slice, mince

('chop', 'slice' and 'mince' are words used for cutting with a knife; whereas 'trim' is to cut a part with a pair of scissors)

1. plodded, galloped, scrambled, trudged
2. tender, delicate, soft, smooth
3. stared, peered, pecked, gazed
4. growing, blossoming, progressing, planting

- II Choose the most suitable taste words given in the box below and write against the food items that follow.

sweet	sour	tangy	bitter
spicy	salty	bland (tasteless)	

- tamarind
- jaggery
- neem leaves
- paneer (cottage cheese)
- lemon
- pickle
- a dish of vegetables



Now, use any five taste words and make sentences of your own.

- III. Choose the correct antonyms for the textual words given below from the box. There are two extra words that you will not need.

growing	ordinary	unprotected	cheerful	hard
wide	fasting	shaky	fussing	coldness

1. tender		5. feasting	
2. sturdy		6. grumpy	
3. narrow		7. sheltered	
4. warmth		8. special	

- IV Read the following lines from the text and underlined verbs. the form of tense.

- Rakesh was on his way home from school when he bought the cherries.
- Rakesh was looking for Grandfather without finding him in any of his favourite places around the house.
- Rakesh and Grandfather gazed at the tree as though it had performed a miracle.



Now, fill in the blanks with the correct form of Simple Past, Past Progressive, or Past Perfect Tenses of the verbs given in brackets. One example has been done for you.

(i) I was sitting (sit) with my grandparents in the garden, sharing the wonderful memories from my childhood. As we (ii) _____ (talk), I (iii) _____ (realise) how much wisdom they (iv) _____ (impart) to me over the years. While I (v) _____ (listen) to their stories for hours together, I (vi) _____ (remember) the times we (vii) _____ (spend) together planting flowers and learning about life. By the time I left, the sun (viii) _____ (set), and I (ix) _____ (feel) a deep sense of gratitude for the bond we (x) _____ (nurture) through love, care, and countless memories.

V Study the punctuation marks in the following sentences from the text.

- *“Hey, not there,” said Grandfather, “I’ve sown mustard in that bed. Plant it in that shady corner; where it won’t be disturbed.”*
- *When Grandfather saw what had happened, he went after the woman and scolded her; but the damage could not be repaired.*
- *She did not try to avoid the tree: one sweep, and the cherry tree was cut in two.*

Punctuation refers to the symbols used in writing to clarify meaning and separate sentences and their components. Proper punctuation ensures the clarity and flow of a text, guiding readers through its structure.

Here are some of the most common punctuation marks:

- Full stop (.)—ends a declarative sentence
For example: She went to the store.
- Comma (,)—separates components in a list, clauses, or phrases within a sentence
For example: We bought apples, oranges, and bananas.
- Question Mark (?)—ends a direct question
For example: Where are you going?
- Exclamation Mark (!)—indicates strong emotion or emphasis
For example: Watch out !

- Colon (:)—introduces a list, explanation or elaboration
For example: He had one goal: win the race.
- Semicolon (;)—connects closely related independent clauses or separates complex list items
For example: She likes reading; he prefers writing.
- Apostrophe (')
 - ✓ In contractions—He's (He is), they'll (they will), I'm (I am)
 - ✓ To show possession—Jagan's book, the girls' toys
 - ✓ If the noun ends in -s, add only the apostrophe—Manas' car
- Quotation Marks (" ")—enclose direct speech or quotations
For example: She said, "I'm happy."
- Dash (– or —)—adds emphasis or separates related thoughts
For example: He was late—again.
- Capitalisation Rules
 - ✓ Names of people and places—Priya, India
 - ✓ Days, months, festivals—Monday, December, Diwali
 - ✓ with names—Dr. Sneha, Mr. Patel
 - ✓ Deities and holy books—God, the Quran, the Bhagawad Gita
 - ✓ First person pronoun—I
 - ✓ Titles of books, poems, or plays—Malgudi Days, The Road Not Taken, Good Heavens, etc.
 - ✓ Adjectives from proper nouns—Indian, American
 - ✓ Geographical features, races, religions, languages—the Himalayas, Hindu, French

Now, punctuate the following paragraph appropriately.

every sunday roshni would visit her grandparents house on their farm
 come sit grandpa would say patting the bench on their porch
 roshni loved these moments where the world slowed down and stories
 flowed like magic grandma would bring tea her eyes twinkling with joy
 im excited to hear about your younger days the adventures the lessons
 and the memories roshni said eagerly
 grandpa smiled softly his wrinkled hands resting on the cane ah the old
 days... when everything was simple and happiness was all we had
 roshni could feel the warmth of those memories he sat in silence bound
 not by words but by a timeless bond



Let us listen



I You will listen to a conversation between a son and his mother. As you listen, select four true statements from 1–7 given below. (Transcript for teacher on page 201)

1. The mother encouraged her son to deliver a presentation on the Chipko Movement.
2. The son was surprised to know about the Appiko Movement.
3. The son agreed that the Chipko Movement was about people uniting to make an impact.
4. The mother expressed a desire to share more details about Saalumarada Thimakka.
5. The mother was curious to hear about Saalumarada Thimakka.
6. The mother and son were in disagreement about the work of Jadav Payeng.
7. The son found the information on Jadav Payeng wonderful.



Let us speak

A **syllable** is a single, unbroken vowel sound in a word. Some words have only one syllable. Some have two and some more than two. For example, the word 'tree' has one syllable. The word 'cherry' has two syllables—che-rry. (Here the hyphen is used to mark the gap between the two syllables.)

A syllable can also be called a 'beat' because you can clap out the 'beats' in the word.

I Work in pairs. Read aloud the following words from the text. Write the number of syllables in each word. Check your answers with your classmates and teacher.

mountains	grandfather	tender	disturbed
caterpillar	Himalayan	performed	intention
slope	newspaper	favourite	

Now, read the words aloud again with the beats. Check if the number of syllables matches with the number of beats.

II Speak about Van Mahotsav Diwas and its significance. Before you speak in the class or assembly, prepare yourself on the following points:

- When is it celebrated ?
- Who celebrates it ?
- Why is it celebrated ?
- How is it celebrated ?
- What is the message it conveys ?



Let us write

An article is a piece of writing on a specific topic. It showcases independent opinions expressed by a writer. Articles are published in newspapers, newsletters, magazines, journals, and online portals.

Let us understand how to draft an article for a school magazine.

Remember to

- write the heading or title at the top,
- write the name of the writer below it as a byline, and
- follow the correct layout.
 - ✓ Paragraph 1: Give a brief introduction of the topic or issue. Focus on the main idea of the paragraph.
 - ✓ Paragraph 2: Elaborate by giving facts and advantages.
 - ✓ Paragraph 3: Include consequences and disadvantages.
 - ✓ Paragraph 4: Provide suggestions. End with a word of hope, a word of caution or a call for action.



Now, complete the article for a magazine on 'Trees–Our Lifeline'. Use the words and phrases given in the box below.

absorb carbon dioxide	Moreover, our planet	reduces pollution
Additionally	would stop existing	ensures a better future
climate control	Trees–Our Lifeline	To conclude
If trees were not there		

- (i) _____ -by _____ (write your name and class) Trees are essential for life on Earth. Without them, life as we know (ii) _____. This is the reason why trees are our lifeline. Trees provide us with food, shelter, and even medicine. Trees
- (iii) _____ and release oxygen, helping us breathe. This process also
- (iv) _____ and keeps the environment clean. (v) _____,



trees give us fruits, nuts, and other foods. Trees also help in (vi) _____ and prevention of soil erosion.

(vii) _____, the air would be _____ would (viii) _____ would be barren, lacking food, shelter, and life-giving greenery.

(ix) _____ trees are true friends. Protecting and planting trees (x) _____ for everyone on Earth. Therefore, we must act now to protect and plant more trees, preserving Earth's green lifeline for future generations.



Let us explore

I Did you know that the banyan tree is the National Tree of India ?

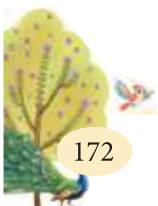
Our country has age-old banyan trees. Some of them are:

1. The Great Banyan, located in Shibpur, Howrah, near Kolkata.
2. Dodda Aalada Mara, located in Kethohalli village, near Bengaluru.
3. Thimmamma Marrimanu, in Anantapur District in Andhra Pradesh. It was recorded as the largest tree specimen in the world in the Guinness Book of World Records in 1989.

II The Chilika Lake in Odisha is a vital echosystem particularly for migratory birds and the Odisha Government has implemented various mesures to protect it. This lake is designed as a wet land of international importance under the Ramsar Convention in 1981 highlighting its global significance.

The core area of Chilika lake Nalabana Island is designated as a Bird sancturary protecting

significant wintering ground for migrating birds. The Chilika Development Authority (CDA) monitors and manages the lake's echosystem including it's water quality. It prevents all illigal actions like Prawn gherries and encroachment.



HARVEST HYMN

Let us do these activities before we read.

I Work in pairs and share your responses with your classmates and teacher.

1. India celebrates many harvest festivals. When is the harvest festival
2. A hymn refers to a song of praise.
 - (i) To whom do we offer a hymn ?
 - (ii) When and where do we sing a hymn ?
 - (iii) Why do we offer it ?

II Work in pairs. Read the paragraph and select the correct meaning for each underlined word from the options given below. Share your answers with your classmates and teacher.

Under the golden 1. radiance of the evening sun, the villagers gathered to pay 2. tribute to their 3. cherished elder, who had dedicated his life to their well-being. His wise 4. counsel had guided generations, steering them through challenges. Known for his 5. munificent spirit, he never hesitated to share his resources generously.

- | | | | |
|---------------|---|---------------|-----------------|
| 1. radiance | : | (i) glow | (ii) brilliance |
| 2. tribute | : | (i) respect | (ii) gratitude |
| 3. cherished | : | (i) preserved | (ii) loved |
| 4. counsel | : | (i) advice | (ii) decision |
| 5. munificent | : | (i) rich | (ii) generous |





Let us read

Men's Voices:

Lord of the lotus, lord of the harvest,
Bright and munificent lord of the morn!
Thine is the bounty that prospered our sowing,
Thine is the bounty that nurtured our corn.
We bring thee our songs and our garlands for tribute,
The gold of our fields and the gold of our fruit;
O giver of mellowing radiance, we hail thee,
We praise thee, O Surya, with cymbal and flute.

Lord of the rainbow, lord of the harvest,
Great and beneficent lord of the main!
Thine is the mercy that cherished our furrows,
Thine is the mercy that fostered our grain.
We bring thee our thanks and our garlands for tribute,
The wealth of our valleys, new-garnered and ripe;
O sender of rain and the dewfall, we hail thee,
We praise thee, Varuna, with cymbal and pipe.



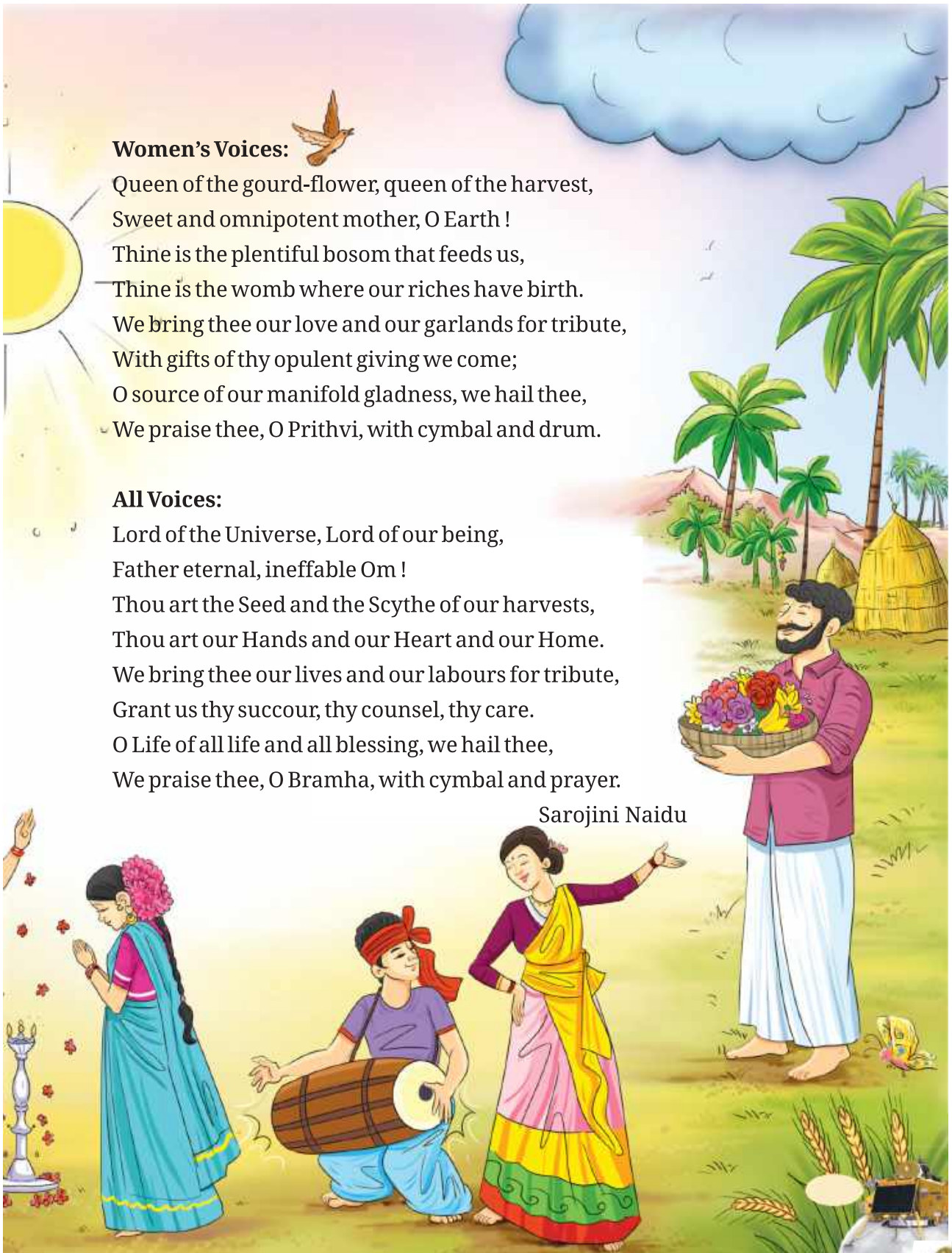
Women's Voices:

Queen of the gourd-flower, queen of the harvest,
 Sweet and omnipotent mother, O Earth !
 Thine is the plentiful bosom that feeds us,
 Thine is the womb where our riches have birth.
 We bring thee our love and our garlands for tribute,
 With gifts of thy opulent giving we come;
 O source of our manifold gladness, we hail thee,
 We praise thee, O Prithvi, with cymbal and drum.

All Voices:

Lord of the Universe, Lord of our being,
 Father eternal, ineffable Om !
 Thou art the Seed and the Scythe of our harvests,
 Thou art our Hands and our Heart and our Home.
 We bring thee our lives and our labours for tribute,
 Grant us thy succour, thy counsel, thy care.
 O Life of all life and all blessing, we hail thee,
 We praise thee, O Bramha, with cymbal and prayer.

Sarojini Naidu



Let us discuss

- I Write the stanza number for the main idea of each stanza given below. Share your answers with your classmates and teacher.

1.	The speakers recognise the lord's kindness and praise him for nourishing the field.	
2.	The speakers praise the generosity of the creator of the universe who ensures a rich harvest.	
3.	The speakers devote their lives and work as a mark of respect to the lord and seek his support, wisdom, and care.	
4.	The speakers pay homage to the Earth and appreciate her role in supporting life, by dedicating their harvest.	
5.	The speaker express their gratitude for the wealth of their village.	

- II Fill in the blanks by choosing the appropriate words or phrases from within the brackets.

- The setting of the poem is a rural landscape, possibly during a _____ (harvest/religious) festival.
- The tone of the poem is respectful and celebratory because it praises _____ (the men and women/ nature and the Lord) with deep respect and gratitude.
- In the line '*Thou art our Hands and our Heart and our Home*', the letter 'h' is capitalised in 'Hands', 'Heart' and 'Home' because _____. (it represents the hard work of farmers/God resides in them)

- III Identify the poetic device used in the following lines from the poem.
- *Bright and munificent lord of the morn!*
 - *We bring thee our lives and our labours for tribute*
- IV Match the lines from the poem in **Column 1** with their expressions in **Column 2**. Choose the appropriate poetic device from the box given below and write in **Column 3**.

imagery alliteration simile metaphor personification

Column 1	Column 2	Column 3
1. <i>sweet and omnipotent mother</i>	(i) creates a clear description of the scene and appeals to the senses	
2. <i>The wealth of our valleys, new-garnered and ripe</i>	(ii) implied comparison of growth and reaping with beginning and end of all life	
3. <i>Thou art the Seed and the Scythe</i>	(iii) the earth is being given human-like qualities	

- V Certain words or phrases are repeated in the same line of the poem. For example, *The gold of our fields and the gold of our fruit*;
Find more such repetitions from the poem. What is the poet's purpose of using repetition in the poem?
- VI The poem uses **symbolism** to convey deeper meanings. Match the symbols in Column 1 with the meanings they convey in Column 2.

Column 1	Column 2
1. <i>Prithvi</i> (the Earth)	(i) light, energy, life—representing the giver of warmth and prosperity
2. <i>Surya</i> (the Sun)	(ii) mercy and nourishment—crucial for agriculture and sustenance
3. <i>Varuna</i> (Rain)	(iii) fertile land, motherhood, nurturing—the source of all life



Let us think and reflect



I Read the given extracts and answer the questions that follow.

1. *We bring thee our songs and our garlands for tribute,
The gold of our fields and the gold of our fruit;
O giver of mellowing radiance, we hail thee,
We praise thee, O Surya, with cymbal and flute.*

- (i) What does the act of bringing songs and garlands as tribute suggest about the people's relationship with the divine?
 - A. They fear the gods and wish to calm them in any way possible.
 - B. They have a deep sense of reverence and gratitude towards the divine.
 - C. They are forced to perform rituals without understanding the divine.
 - D. They depend on the gods for their daily needs and activities.
- (ii) Complete the following sentence suitably.
The word 'gold' in the phrases '*the gold of our fields*' and '*the gold of our fruit*' symbolises _____.
- (iii) How does the description '*O giver of mellowing radiance*' help us understand Surya's role in the harvest?
- (iv) Fill in the blank by selecting the correct option from those given in the brackets.

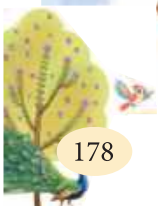
The use of cymbal and flute signifies _____. (joy and celebration/meditation and worship)

2. *All Voices:*

*Lord of the Universe, Lord of our being,
Father eternal, ineffable Om!*

*Thou art the Seed and the Scythe of our harvests,
Thou art our Hands and our Heart and our Home.*

- (i) In the phrase '*Lord of our being*,' what does the word 'being' most likely refer to?
 - A. Our physical body
 - B. Our entire existence
 - C. Our spiritual practices
 - D. Our earthly possessions



- (ii) Identify whether the following statement is true or false.
The imagery of 'the Seed and the Scythe' symbolises the divine's role as both the beginning (creation) and the end (harvest) of the agricultural cycle.
- (iii) Identify the phrases from the extract that mean the following:
A. The divine as a timeless, everlasting presence
B. Beyond human comprehension or description
- (iv) How do we know that these lines from the extract are spoken as a chorus?

II Some poets and authors use words that are no longer a part of common usage. Such words are called archaic words.

Work in pairs. Read the sentences given below. Match the underlined archaic words in Column 1 with their meanings in Column 2. Share your answers with your classmates and teacher.

'Thou art my friend, and I trust thee. Thy kindness is great, and everything that is mine is thine.'

Column 1	Column 2
1. thou	(i) yours
2. art	(ii) you (object)
3. thee	(iii) you (subject)
4. thy	(iv) are
5. thine	(v) your

III. Answer the following questions.

- Why do the farmers hail the God of rain?
- What is being referred to as 'wealth of our valleys'? Why?
- State one reason why the women refer to the Earth as a 'source of manifold gladness'.
- Why does everyone in the poem offer their 'labours for tribute'?
- Why has the poet presented the poem as voices of men, women, and all voices?
- How does the poet create the joyous atmosphere of rural India at harvesting time?
- Why is the poem presented as a hymn?



Let us learn

- I Match the pictures of the farming implements given in Column 1 with their use given in Column 2. Then, fill in the blanks in Column 3 to complete the name of the implement.



Column 1	Column 2	Column 3
1. 	(i) A tool with a long handle with metal teeth for collecting hay or leaves.	S _ C K L _
2. 	(ii) A small hand tool used for digging and making shallow furrows.	S C _ T H _
3. 	(iii) A hand-held tool with a curved blade attached to a short handle. It is used for harvesting crops.	P L _ _ G H
4. 	(iv) A tool pulled by oxen. It is used for turning over the soil in the field so that seeds can be sown or planted.	T R _ W _ L
5. 	(v) A farm tool having a flat rectangular blade attached to a long wooden handle used for digging the soil.	R _ K _
6. 	(vi) A hand-held tool with a long-curved blade attached to a long handle used for cutting tall grass.	S P _ D _

- II Choose the correct synonyms for the underlined words in the given sentences from the box below. Circle the words or phrases in the sentences that helped you to infer the meanings. One example has been done for you.

generous help brightness indescribable kind

- The king was beneficent to the poor because he took good care of them.
synonym: kind
- He was *munificent* towards the needy and donated a lot for their health care.
synonym: _____

3. When he lost his job, all his friends gave him succour by supporting him with money.

synonym: _____

4. When the sun's rays came into the dark room, the whole room was full of radiance.

synonym: _____

5. The little girl was speechless with ineffable joy when she got her birthday gift from her aunt.

synonym: _____



Let us listen

- I Listen to the talk about paddy cultivation. As you listen, number the events in the correct order in which they happen. (Transcript for teacher on page 203)

1. Transplanting of seedlings
2. Ploughing of soil
3. Threshing of grains
4. Puddling of land
5. Harvesting of paddy
6. Irrigating the field
7. Milling of rice



- II Now, listen to the talk again. As you listen, choose the correct option to answer the questions that follow.

1. What is the main step in preparing the soil for cultivation of rice?
(i) Ploughing the soil (ii) Clearing the soil (iii) Puddling the soil
2. How long does it take for rice seeds to grow into seedlings before being transplanted?
(i) 2–3 weeks (ii) 4–5 weeks (iii) 6–7 weeks



3. Why is drying rice grains important after threshing?
- To get rice seeds for plantation
 - To separate the rice grains easily
 - To store the rice grains for longer



Let us speak

I In English, some letters are not pronounced in certain words. For example, in words like 'knife', 'knowledge', and 'know', the first letter 'k' is not pronounced. Let us look at a few more such examples.

- In the words given below the letter 'n' is silent when it appears with 'm' at the end of the word.

hymn, column, autumn, solemn

Now, say these words aloud.

- In the words given below the letter 'b' is silent when it appears with 'm'.

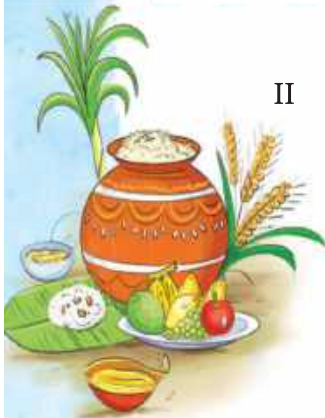
womb, tomb, bomb, climb, comb

Now, say these words aloud.

II In our country, harvest is celebrated with the preparation of delicious dishes. Work in groups and make a presentation on any popular dish made during the harvest festival in your region. Use the prompts given in the box to make your presentation. Make sure that all the members share their views.

Include the following:

- What is the dish called? Is it known by any other name in other parts of India?
- What ingredients are used to make the dish?
- How is the dish prepared?
- How is the dish served?
- What does the dish taste like?
- What is the special ritual related to the preparation of this dish?
- Describe any special memory associated with the preparation of this dish.



Column 1	Column 2
Greet the audience	Good morning to all of you gathered here...
Introduce the members of your group and your topic	Today we, ____, ____, and ____ are here to tell you about...
Explain the structure of your presentation	• We will start off with... • Following this, we will move on to... • The next point we will deal with is... • Finally, we will speak about...
Speak about the first point	• Let's begin by... • I'd like to start by...
Describe the details	• Now I'll move on to... • Next... • I'd like to now discuss... • Let's now consider... • Let me tell you about
Conclude your presentation	• In conclusion, I'd like to say... • To summarise...
Thank the audience	• Thank you for listening. • Thank you for your attention.



Let us write

Creative slogans are used to spread a message to capture the reader's attention. Some examples are given below:

- Education is the Key, Unlock Your Destiny!
- Protect the Environment Today for a Better Tomorrow
- Learn, Grow, Succeed
- Go Green by Keeping the Planet Clean

Your school wishes to express gratitude to the farmers who play an important role in providing us the food on our plates. Draft a creative slogan to be put up on the school notice board.



Remember to

- focus on the main idea to be expressed
- use simple language
- be concise—express yourself in a few words

You may write the slogan on a chart paper and decorate it.

**Let us explore**

I Millets are a varied group of small-seeded grasses. They have more fibre and minerals than other cereals. Millets have been a part of the Indian cuisine for years. They have been rediscovered worldwide as superfoods.

1. Read the information on Pearl Millet given below.

Pearl Millet (Pennisetum glaucum (L.) R. Br.)

Common name:
Bajra

Vernacular names:

Spiked millet or Pearl millet (English),
Bajra (Bengali, Hindi, Oriya, Punjabi, Urdu),
Bajree (Rajasthani, Gujarati, Marathi),
Sajje (Kannada), Kambu (Tamil),
Sajja (Telugu)

Cultivation areas:

Rajasthan,
Maharashtra,
Gujarat,
Uttar Pradesh and
Haryana

Nutritional Profile:

Highest niacin content amongst all cereals; rich in protein and dietary fiber.

NUTRIENTS	VALUE PER 100 GRAMS
Energy (Kcal)	347
Protein (g)	10.9
Fat (g)	5.43
Carbohydrate (g)	61.8
Ca (mg)	27.4
Fe (mg)	6.4
Folic Acid (µg)	36.1

It is the sixth major cereal in terms of area and production and has the highest drought tolerance potential of all millets. Pearl millet is the most widely cultivated cereal in India after rice and wheat.

Health benefits:

- Reduces cholesterol
- Promotes bone health
- Beneficial in treating stomach ulcers
- Promotes heart health
- Aids in weight loss

Uses: Khichdi, Roti, Upma, Idli, Khakhra, Parathas

Use the link given below to know more about other kinds of millets.

<https://eatrightindia.gov.in/millets2023/assets/documents/Millets%20-%20Nutritious%20Cereal%20of%20India.pdf>

2. Work in groups of four and do the following activities.

- Find out if millets are a part of your cuisine.
- Find recipes with millets and compile them into a booklet.
- Create a recipe of your choice.

II Songs related to harvest season form a part of our culture and heritage.

Talk to the elders in your house and learn a song sung on a harvest festival. Share it with your classmates and teacher. Then, compile all the songs to create a songbook with the help of teacher.

WAITING FOR THE RAIN

Let us do these activities before we read.

- I Have you ever waited for the rains? Why?
- II How do you feel when it rains after a long time?
- III Why do you think the farmers wait for the rains?
- IV Discuss in groups what happens when you wait for something or someone for a long period of time.
 1. How do you spend the waiting period ?
 2. What do you think about ?
 3. How do you feel ?

Share your answers with your classmates and teacher.

